Cain and Abel

Genesis 4–5

The big idea: Sin grows up fast: a brother kills a brother, and a descendant boasts of revenge. God warns Cain before the murder and shows him mercy after it, and two family lines run side by side.

Before you meet: Read

Genesis 4 | Genesis 5:1–5, 21–24

Open (5 minutes)

Think of a small problem you ignored that grew into a big one: a leak, a debt, a grudge. What happened?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

God warned Cain, "If you do not do well, sin is _____ at the door. Its desire is for you, and you must _____ over it." *(Genesis 4:7)*

Lamech boasted, "If Cain's revenge is sevenfold, then Lamech's is _____." *(Genesis 4:24)*

"At that time people began to _____ upon the name of the LORD." *(Genesis 4:26)*

Discuss

1. God told Cain that sin was "crouching at the door." What does it look like to "rule over it"? What help do Christians have that Cain did not? *Genesis 4:6–7*

2. Lamech multiplied revenge. Jesus multiplied forgiveness. Why is keeping score so natural to us? What would it take for you to stop? *Genesis 4:24; Matthew 18:21–22*

3. Two family lines ran side by side, one building its own name and one calling on the name of the LORD. What does it look like to call on his name today? *Genesis 4:17–26*

Memory verse

> *"Its desire is for you, and you must rule over it."*
>
> **Genesis 4:7**

Pray

Name to God the sin crouching at your door, and ask for his help to rule over it. Pray for one person you are keeping score against.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 9

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Genesis 4:1–16 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the three fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Genesis 6–9 and Genesis 11:1–9).

Main points to land

1. Sin grows. From one bite of fruit to a murder, a song of revenge, a world filled with violence, and a tower of pride (Genesis 4:8, 23–24; 6:11; 11:4).
2. God speaks to sinners before they fall and after: a warning to Cain, then a question, then a mark of mercy (Genesis 4:6–15).
3. Two lines run side by side: one building its own name, and one calling on the name of the LORD (Genesis 4:17–26).

Answer key (Observe)

1. crouching; rule
2. seventy-sevenfold
3. call

Questions people will ask

Where did Cain get his wife?

Adam and Eve had other sons and daughters (Genesis 5:4). Cain married a sister or another close relative, long before God forbade such marriages (Leviticus 18:6–18). Genesis does not name her; its attention is on Cain's heart.

Closing prayer

Father, we see ourselves in Cain's anger and Lamech's score-keeping. Thank you that you warned Cain before he sinned and showed him mercy after. Help us rule over the sin at our door by your Spirit, and teach us to call on your name. Amen.